

# Chengyu Fang

University of Cincinnati | fangcu@ucmail.uc.edu

## EDUCATION

---

- Ph.D.**, Communication, University of California, Santa Barbara (UCSB) 09/2018 — 08/2026  
Dissertation Committee: Ronald Rice (Chair), Jenn Gibbs, Young Ji Kim
- M.A.**, Communication, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC) 08/2016 — 05/2018  
Emphases in Organizational Communication and Group Communication  
Advisor: Marshall Scott Poole, Ph.D.
- B.A.**, Double Major, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign 01/2014 — 05/2016  
High Distinction (Communication)  
Thesis: *Demographics, Health Information Seeking, Health Outcomes among Young Adults*  
Advisor: Cabral Bigman-Galimore, Ph.D.  
Highest Distinction (Sociology)

- B.S.**, Psychology, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign 01/2014 — 05/2016  
Social/Personality Psychology Concentration

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

---

- Visting Assistant Professor, School of Communication, Film & Media 08/2026 — present  
University of Cincinnati
- Teaching Assistant, Department of Communication, UCSB 04/2019 — 06/2026
- Teaching Associate, Department of Communication, UCSB 2020 Summer/2022 Winter/2022 Summer  
2023 Summer/2024 Winter/2024 Summer  
2025 Summer
- Graduate Student Researcher, Department of Communication, UCSB 04/2022 — 06/2024  
08/2021 — 12/2021
- Teaching Assistant, Department of Communication, UIUC 08/2016 — 05/2018
- Research Assistant, Department of Communication, UIUC 08/2016 — 12/2016

## PUBLICATIONS

---

### Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Zhang, C. X., Rice, R. E., & Fang, C. (2026). Exploring personal digital media environments: A

configural approach to digital stress. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 17, 1867928.  
<https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2026.1867928>

Kim, Y. J., Zhang, C. X., & **Fang, C.** (2025). Navigating the human-AI divide: Boundary work in the age of generative AI. *Computers in Human Behavior: Artificial Humans*, 6, 100214.  
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbah.2025.100214>

Wilkenfeld, J., Dunbar, N., **Fang, C.** & Srinivasan, D. (2024). Power and Synchrony in Human Collaboration with Exoskeletons. In L. Fortunati & A. Edwards (Ed.), *The De Gruyter Handbook of Robots in Society and Culture* (pp. 467-488). Berlin, Boston: De Gruyter.  
<https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110792270-025>

Gibbs, J. L., Eisenberg, J., **Fang, C.**, & Wilkenfeld, J. (2023). Examining how organizational continuities and discontinuities affect the job satisfaction of global contractors. *Journal of International Management*, 29(5), 101046–101046. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.intman.2023.101046>

**Fang, C.**, Wilkenfeld, J. N., Navick, N., & Gibbs, J. L. (2023). “AI Am Here to Represent You”: Understanding How Institutional Logics Shape Attitudes Toward Intelligent Technologies in Legal Work. *Management Communication Quarterly*, 0(0).  
<https://doi.org/10.1177/08933189231158282>

Gibbs, J. L., Kirkwood, G. L., **Fang, C.**, & Wilkenfeld, J. N. (2021). Negotiating agency and control: Theorizing human-machine communication from a structurational perspective. *Human-Machine Communication*, 2(1), 153-171. <https://doi.org/10.30658/hmc.2.8>

Barley, W. C., Dinh, L., Workman, H., & **Fang, C.** (2020). Exploring the Relationship Between Interdisciplinary Ties and Linguistic Familiarity Using Multilevel Network Analysis. *Communication Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0093650220926001>

### **Conference proceedings**

Yan, B., Lewis, K., Figge, P., Hollingshead, A., Alexander, K. S., Kim, Y. J., & **Fang, C.** (2020). Intelligent Machines and Teamwork: Help or Hindrance? *Academy of Management Proceedings*, 2020(1), 21962. <https://doi.org/10.5465/AMBPP.2020.140>. [Best Paper Award]

### **Work in Progress**

**Fang, C.**, & Rice, R. E. (revise and resubmit). Organizing in public: How transparent hybrid organizing constitutes teams and fields in digital esports. Manuscript to be submitted to a special issue of *Management Communication Quarterly*.

### **PRESENTATIONS**

---

#### **Refereed Conference Papers**

Zhang, C. X., **Fang, C.**, & Rice, R. E. (2026, June). Beyond screen time: A configural approach to digital well-being. Paper to be presented at the Sunbelt 2026 Annual Conference of the International Network for Social Network Analysis, Daytona Beach, FL.

Zhang, C. X., Rice, R. E., & **Fang, C.** (2026, June). Beyond screen time: A configural approach to digital

- well-being. Paper to be presented at the 76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Zhang, C. X., Rice, R. E., & **Fang, C.** (2026, June). Media use for strong vs. weak ties: A configural examination of digital well-being. Paper to be presented at the 76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association, Cape Town, South Africa.
- Fang, C.** (2025, November). *Streaming in the Spotlight: Team Adaptation and Institutional Work in Hybrid, Transparent Esports Organizations*. Paper presented at the 111th National Communication Association Annual Conference. Denver, CO.
- Kim, Y. J., Zhang, C. X., & **Fang, C.** (2024, November). *Blurred Lines, Bridging Minds: College Students' Strategies for Navigating the Blurred Boundaries between Human Intelligence and Generative AI*. Paper presented at the 110th National Communication Association Annual Conference. New Orleans, LA.
- Fang, C.** (2022, November). *"Talk the Walk"?: Examining texts in Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) Reports from an Institutional Perspective*. Paper presented at the 108th National Communication Association Annual Conference. New Orleans, LA.
- Gibbs, J., Eisenberg, J., **Fang, C.**, & Wilkenfeld, J. N. (2022). Organizational continuities and discontinuities and the job satisfaction of Global Contractors. *Academy of Management Proceedings*, 2022(1). <https://doi.org/10.5465/ambpp.2022.15303abstract>
- Fang, C.**, Wilkenfeld, J. N., Navick, N., Gibbs, J. L., (2021, November) "AI Am Here to Represent You": Exploring Use of Intelligent Technologies in the Legal Industry. Paper presented at the 107th National Communication Association Annual Conference. Seattle, WA.
- Fang, C.**, Kim, Y. J. (2020, November) *"It's in the game": Team Adaptability in Esports Teams from a Longitudinal Perspective*. Paper presented at the 106th National Communication Association Annual Conference. Indianapolis, IN.  
<https://www.natcom.org/convention-events/virtual-2020-convention>
- Fang, C.**, Wilkenfeld, J. N., Navick, N., Gibbs, J. L., (2020, November) "AI Am Here to Represent You": Exploring Use of Intelligent Technologies in the Legal Industry. Paper presented in the Research Escalator section at the 106th National Communication Association Annual Conference. Indianapolis, IN. <https://www.natcom.org/convention-events/virtual-2020-convention>
- Fang, C.**, Kim, Y. J. (2020, October) *"Which Lane Should I Play?": A Qualitative Exploration of Team Adaptability in Esports Teams*. Paper presented at the 2020 UCI Esports Conference. Irvine, CA.
- Yan, B., Lewis, K., Figge, P., Hollingshead, A. B., Alexander, K. S., Kim, Y. J., **Fang, C.** (2020, August). *Intelligent Machines and Teamwork: Help or Hindrance?* Paper presented at the Academy of Management 2020 Convention, Vancouver, Canada. **Best Paper Award**.
- Fang, C.**, Kim, Y. J. (2020, July). *Sources and Types: Conceptualizing Team Diversity from a Multidimensional Perspective*. Paper to be presented at Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research (INGroup) 15th Annual Conference. Seattle, WA.

- Yan, B., Figge, P., Lewis, K., Hollingshead, A. B., Alexander, K. S., Kim, Y. J., Shaikh, S., Cruz, I., **Fang, C.**, Wilkenfeld, J. N. (2019, July). *Alexa, what is the Pythagorean Theorem? The influence of intelligent personal assistants on transactive memory systems*. Paper presented at Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research (INGRoup) 14th Annual Conference. Lisbon, Portugal.
- Ruge-Jones, L., Proulx, J., Campbell, A. D., Pilny, A. **Fang, C.**, Dobosh, M., Yahja, A., Poole, M. S. (2019, July). *Development and application of a coding system for capturing expressed uncertainty and uncertainty management in action teams and groups*. Paper to be presented at INGRoup 14th Annual Conference. Lisbon, Portugal.
- Gibbs, J. L., **Fang, C.**, Kirkwood, G., Wilkenfeld, J. N. (2019, May). *Putting the AI in Team: Reconceptualizing Team Processes When Technologies Are Teammates*. Paper presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference. Washington, DC.
- Fang, C.** (2018, November). *Communicating Expertise: A Qualitative Study in a Knowledge-Intensive Incubator for Startups*. Paper presented at the 104th National Communication Association Annual Conference. Salt Lake City, UT.
- Poole, M. S., Proulx, J., Pilny, A., Ruge-Jones, L., **Fang, C.**, Dinh, L., Yahja, A., Melissa, D. (2018, July) *The Antecedents and Outcomes of Dynamic Communication Interaction Patterns in Multi-Team Systems*. Paper presented at 2018 INGRoup conference. Bethesda, MD.
- Fang, C.** (2018, May). *Expertise and Embodiment: "How do we know who knows what?"*. Paper presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference. Prague, Czech Republic.
- Poole, M. S., Proulx, J., Dinh, L., **Fang, C.**, Ruge-Jones, L., Pilny, A., Yahja, A., Melissa, D. (2017, July) *Epistemic Anchoring Processes: The Impact of Sensemaking Communication on Team Processes and Outcomes*. Paper presented at 2017 INGRoup conference. St. Louis, MO
- Pilny, A., Dinh, L., **Fang, C.**, Poole, M. S., Proulx, J., Ruge-Jones, L. and Yahja, A. (2017, June) *Building dynamic networks from trace data versus human coded interactions: A comparison of two collection methods*. Poster presented at 2017 International School and Conference on Network Science. Indianapolis, IN.
- Fang, C.**, & Dinh, L., (2017, June). *Exploring interdisciplinary collaboration networks: the effects of formal and informal network structures*. Poster presented at the Sunbelt 2017 Annual Conference of International Network for Social Network Analysis. Beijing, China.
- Barley, W.C., Dinh, L., Workman, H.M., **Fang, C.** (2017, May) *Examining the Structure of Interactional Expertise in a Scientific Organization using Multilevel Egocentric Network Analysis*. Paper presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference. San Diego, CA.  
**Best of the B.E.S.T. Presentation Award.**
- Lammers, J.C., Bryan, A.L., **Fang, C.** (2017, May) *Re-conceptualizing Institutional Messages to Explain Institutional Collisions*. Paper presented at the International Communication Association Annual Conference. San Diego, CA.

**Fang, C. & Ruge-Jones, L.** (2016, October) *Combat: The Effects of Team Structure on Communication Climate and Performance Outcomes*. Poster presented at 2016 Organizational Communication Mini-Conference. Northwestern University, IL

Proulx, J., **Fang, C.**, & Mozelle, J. (2016, April). *Collaboration networks and structural influence in mental health*. Paper presented at the Sunbelt 2016 Annual Conference of the International Network for Social Network Analysis. Newport Beach, California.

**Fang, C.** (2015, April). *Factors Contributing to Civic Engagement among Chinese Immigrants to the United States*. Paper presented at 2015 Undergraduate Research Symposium. University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Urbana, IL

**Fang, C.** (2015, April). *Health information seeking behaviors: Individual characteristics, Media consuming behaviors, past health habits, and health knowledge diversity*. Clement S. Stacy Undergraduate Research Conference. University of Purdue, IN

## OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

---

### Multiteam Systems Lab Research Team

*Transcribed audio recordings of experimental data; Participated in designing and running lab experiments; Collaboratively developed Uncertainty Management coding scheme; Coded transcripts based on the coding systems developed*

Supervising Faculty: Marshall Scott Poole

### Network Analysis of Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders

Graduate Mentor: Jeffrey Proulx

### Health Disparities Content Analysis Team Project (HD-CAT)

*“Racial Health Disparities Coverage in the USA Today and the New York Times: Prominence, Message Effects, and Unanswered Questions.”*

Graduate Mentor: David Roache

Supervising Faculty: Cabral Bigman-Galimore

### Other Labs:

Culture and Social Behavior Lab

Supervising Faculty: Ph.D. Dov Cohen

Social Action Lab

Supervising Faculty: Ph.D. Dolores Albarracin

Lifelong Brain and Cognition Lab

Beckman Institute, *University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign*

## GRANTS AND AWARDS

---

**Designing Learning with AI Grant, \$2822.50**

07/2025-05/2026

Office of the Associate Vice Chancellor of Teaching and Learning

*University of California, Santa Barbara*

**NCA Doctoral Honors Seminar: Communication Theory and Research track**

06/2022

Competitively selected and the seminar was held at George Mason University

**Graduate Student Research Grant, \$500** 06/2020

Department of Communication, *University of California, Santa Barbara*

**Regents Fellowship** 09/2018-06/2019

Department of Communication, *University of California, Santa Barbara*

**Elizabeth Winter Young Summer Fellowship** 06/2017-08/2017

Department of Communication, *University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign*

**Best of the B.E.S.T. Presentation Award** 05/2017

“Examining the structure of interactional expertise in a scientific organization using multilevel egocentric analysis” (Co-authored with William Barley, Ly Dinh, and Hallie Workman)

*International Communication Association, Organizational Communication Division*

**Joseph Wenzel Award, \$1000** 05/2016

Department of Communication, *University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign*

**Best Undergraduate Student Paper Award** 05/2016

Department of Sociology, *University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign*

Departmental Honors 05/2016

High Distinction, B.A., Department of Communication

Highest Distinction, B.A., Department of Sociology

Dean’s List: Fall 2014; Spring 2015

## **TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

---

Department of Communication, *University of California, Santa Barbara*

### Teaching Assistant

COMM 1: Introduction to Communication (Spring 2019, Summer 2019)

COMM 88: Communication Research Methods (Spring 2020, Spring 2025)

COMM 104: Evolution and Human Communication (Fall 2024)

COMM 107: Interpersonal Communication (Spring 2021)

COMM 131: Organizational Communication: A Global Perspective (Fall 2020)

COMM 136: Collaborative Technologies and the Dynamics of Organization (Winter 2020)

COMM 137: Global Communication, International Relations and the Media (Fall 2019)

COMM 169: Social Networks (Winter 2021)

COMM 160DM. Consumer Behavior in a Digital World (Summer 2021)

### Teaching Associate

COMM 1: Introduction to Communication (Summer 2020 – managing 1 TA)  
COMM 88: Communication Research Methods (Summer 2025 – managing 1 TA)  
COMM 122: Organizational Communication (Winter 2022, Summer 2022; Summer 2024)  
COMM 131: Organizational Communication: A Global Perspective (Summer 2023)  
COMM 137: Global Communication, International Relations and the Media (Winter 2024)

Department of Political Science, *University of California, Santa Barbara*

Teaching Assistant

POL S 7 - Introduction to International Relations (Winter 2025)

Department of Communication, *University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign*

CMN 101: Public Speaking (Fall 2016)

CMN 102: Introduction to Communication Theory and Research (Spring 2017, Fall 2017,  
Spring 2018)

Lead Teaching Assistant (Fall 2017)

Teaching Development

Teachers Ranked as Excellent (Spring 2018)

STIA (Summer Teaching Institute for Associates) Certificate (Summer 2020)

Pillars of Teaching Assistantship Certificate (Winter 2022)

**SERVICE**

---

**TO THE DISCIPLINE**

**Service to Professional Associations**

Student & Early Career Representative of Communication and Technology Division, ICA  
(2022- 2024)

Department Representative at WSCA General Assembly (2020, 2021)

**Journal Reviewer**

Emerging Reviewer for *Management Communication Quarterly* (2023-present)

Ad Hoc Reviewer for *Human-Machine Communication*, 2025

**Editorial Assistant**

Communication Research (06/2021 – 09/2021)

**Memberships**

National Communication Association (NCA)

International Communication Association (ICA)

Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research (INGRoup)

Western States Communication Association (WSCA)

## **Paper Reviewer**

Group Communication Division, NCA (2021)  
Human Communication and Technology Division, NCA (2020, 2023)  
Organizational Communication Division  
Interdisciplinary Network for Group Research Conference (2020)  
Computational Methods Interest Group, ICA (2017; 2018)  
Communication and Technology Division, ICA (2018- 2020)  
Academy of Management (2021)

## **Panel Chair**

Interpersonal Communication Division, ICA (2020)  
Communication and Technology Division, ICA (2020)  
Human Communication and Technology Division, NCA (2020)

## **Respondent**

Scholar to Scholar Session, National Communication Association (2020)

## **TO THE UNIVERSITY**

**Graduate Scholars Program Mentor** (2022-2023) University of California, Santa Barbara

**Beyond Academia Conference** University of California, Santa Barbara

Executive Team Co-chair (2024)  
Logistics Committee Co-chair (2023)

**Search Advisory Committee for Associate Vice Chancellor for Information Technology and Chief Information Officer**, Graduate Student Association Representative (2021)

University of California, Santa Barbara

**Ombuds Advisory Committee**, Graduate Representative (2019 – 2021)

University of California, Santa Barbara

**UCSB Graduate Student Association**, Department Representative

## **TO THE DEPARTMENT**

**Department of Communication, UCSB**

**Search Committee Member**, Graduate Representative  
Assist. Professor in Digital Communication (2019 – 2020)

**Graduate Student Advisory Committee to the Chair (GSACC)**

Department Representative to Graduate Student Association (2021-2022)  
DEI Rep (2022-2023)



**Panelist, Graduate Open House**

Off-campus Housing (2023)

Zoom Rooms with Graduate Students (2022)

Interdisciplinary Emphases and Certificate (2020)

**Graduate student Buddy for new-grad student recruitment** (2019-2020)

**Department of Communication, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign**

**New Student Mentor**, Graduate Student Association (2017 – 2018)